CONTROLLED CATASTROPHE ENGINE — DM RUN SHEET

Prison Core → Release → True Storm → Escape

STARTING VALUES

Tracker	Start
Chain-Lock	Breaches +1 if Control 2; max 4
Integrity	6 − Structural; min 2
Overload	previous Pressure; 6→5
Sky Vent	0
Escape Ready	1 if no split + Structural 0–1
Disposition	Hostile / Defiant / Bargained / Aligned

ROUND ENGINE

- Initiative 20: Catastrophe Pulse at Overload 3+.
- Initiative 10: Anaxaster assist or hostile pressure.
- End round: Chain-Lock 3+ → Overload +1. Overload 6+ → Integrity −1 unless prevented.
- Round 7 end: Overload at least 7; trigger Last Choice.

PHASES

Phase	Trigger	Goal
I Cut Definition	Start → Lock 4	Advance Lock; prep escape.
II Deep Recognizes	Lock 4 / Overload 4	Build Vent; protect Integrity.
III Open Sky	Lock 5 + Vent 2	Vent 3–4; position Crew.
IV Disagreement	Matthael chooses	Resolve conduit.
V Release / Escape	Success / branch	Blast, storm state, 4 beats.

LAST CHOICE

Integrity 0, Overload 8, or round limit: freeze initiative. Matthael chooses Conduit, Abort, or Let Anaxaster Tear Free. Failure never becomes automatic TPK.

CORE ACTIONS

Task	DC / result
Chain-Lock	Arcana 17 · Tools 16 · Athletics 18 · Nature 17 · Grudgebell 16. Success +1.
Sky Vent	Relay 16 · Glass 17 · Root 16 · Radiance 17 · Mira 17 · raw 4th+ slot 17.
Stabilise	Athletics/Nature 16 · Arcana 17. Prevent loss or Integrity +1.
Escape Prep	Perception/Survival/route action 15–16. Escape +1.
Anaxaster	Assist if Bargained/Aligned; hostile action if Hostile.

MATTHAEL'S DISAGREEMENT

Element	Rule
Requirements	Chain-Lock 5+ · Sky Vent 3+.
Roll	CHA(Arcana) DC 18.
Fuel	3 SP = advantage · 4th+ slot = +2, Overload −1 · Rift = Vent +1 req.
DC +2	Vent only 3 · GLASS missing · Overload 7.
Success	Route overload upward; true storm begins.
Failure	Abort · Reconfigure · Force Through.
Force Through	Auto success; 6d6 force/psychic, all SP, 1 exhaustion; no Crowned Storm.

PULSES / TRACK THRESHOLDS

- Overload 3–4: one pulse. 5–6: two zones or +1d6. 7: two different pulses. 8: Last Choice.
- Integrity 3: escape complication. 2: DC +1. 1: threshold collapse. 0: Last Choice.
- Sky Vent 3 unlocks Disagreement; 4 improves storm tier.
- Escape Ready spends: auto-pass beat, recover ally, or negate damage consequence.

HARD LOCKS

Only Matthael's deliberate upward routing creates the true storm. No physical Barten. Deeper force stays unnamed. Matthael learns to hear the storm in Stormwake, not here.